

STAGE EIGHT • SOFT SKILLS

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Eight • Soft Skills

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage's pre-work is less about logistics (devices, accounts) and more about emotional preparation — several sessions genuinely benefit from participants knowing what kind of engagement to expect before they arrive.

Before Session 1: Communication & Listening

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- No preparation required. Just arrive ready to talk and listen with a real partner — this session is highly interactive from the start.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session builds foundational habits used throughout the rest of the stage. The only genuine preparation is a willingness to practice out loud, not alone.

Before Session 2: Emotional Intelligence & Self-Awareness

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Think of a recent, moderate disagreement you could reference honestly — not your most painful one, something you can reflect on with some emotional distance.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several exercises ask you to reflect on a real disagreement. Choosing an appropriately-scoped one in advance means you're not searching for an example cold, or accidentally reaching for something too raw.

Before Session 3: Feedback & Conflict Resolution

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- This session involves giving and receiving real, direct feedback, and role-playing conflict scenarios. Know that going in, and know it's genuinely normal to feel some anxiety about it.
- If you have a real, current, low-stakes disagreement you've been avoiding, consider whether this session might be a good moment to finally address it.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the most emotionally demanding session in the program so far. Arriving mentally prepared for that, rather than surprised by it, makes a real difference.

Before Session 4: Teamwork & Collaboration

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- No preparation required. This session runs mostly in consistent small groups — you'll likely be assigned a team you'll stay with for the full session.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Knowing this session is genuinely collaborative, not individual reflection, helps you show up ready to engage with others from the start.

Before Session 5: Networking & Public Speaking

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Think of one topic you could speak comfortably about for 60–90 seconds unprepared — something you genuinely know or care about.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several exercises use a topic you already know well as the vehicle for practicing delivery and confidence, so having one ready saves real session time.

Before Session 6: Growth Mindset & Resilience

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- No preparation required. This is the stage's closing, reflective session — arrive with genuine openness to look back honestly across everything from all six sessions.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The value of this closing session depends entirely on real honesty, including about the parts of this stage that were genuinely difficult.